FIFA WORLD CUP | 1930 – 2022

WORLD CUP ANALYSIS

Performance, Goals & Hosting Effects

22	2,720	964	Brazil
Tournaments	Total Goals	Matches	Most Wins (5x)

The Beautiful Game — A Data Story

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Objectives

What This Analysis Sets Out to Uncover

1. **Track Goal Trends**
   Analyse how total goals scored per tournament have changed across 92 years of World Cup football from 1930 to 2022.

2. **Identify Dominant Teams**
   Determine which nations have dominated the tournament, with a focus on Champions, Runner-Ups and consistent performers.

3. **Measure Hosting Impact**
   Evaluate whether hosting the World Cup provides a tangible competitive advantage to the host nation in matches and titles.

4. **Explore Attendance Growth**
   Understand how global interest in the World Cup has grown over the decades through attendance data across all 22 editions.

5. **Surface Key Insights**
   Deliver clear, data-backed insights that teams, governing bodies and football analysts can learn from and act on.

Tournament Overview | 1930 – 2022

92 Years of the World's Biggest Football Event

22
Tournaments Held

2,720
All-Time Goals

964
Total Matches

44M+
Total Attendance

Brazil
Most Titles (5×)

13 Goals
Just Fontaine 1958

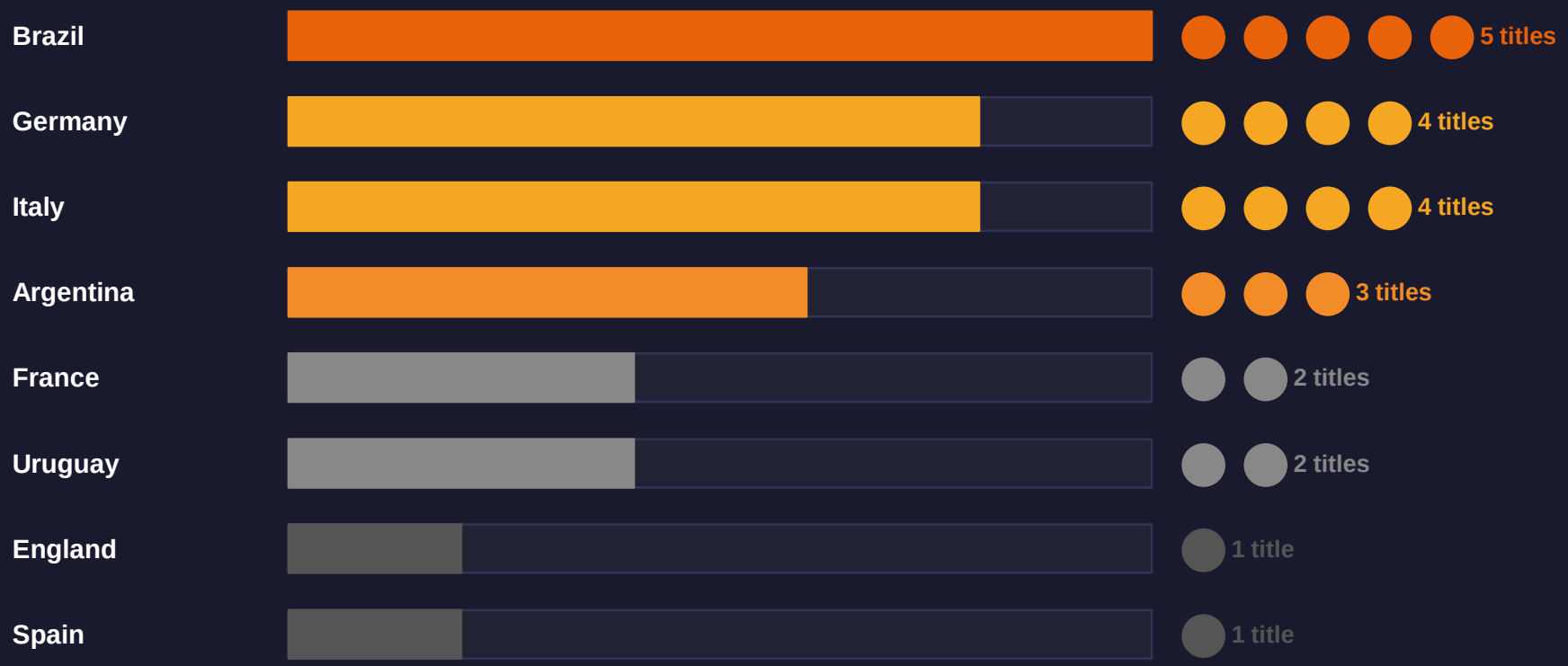
3.59M
Highest Attendance '94

Tournament Evolution at a Glance

- **30** — First ever World Cup Uruguay
- **50** — Record attendance 173,850 fans
- **66** — First live global TV broadcast
- **82** — Expanded to 24 teams
- **94** — Record total attendance 3.59 million
- **98** — Expanded to 32 teams
- **22** — First Middle East host Qatar

World Cup Champions | Who Dominated the Tournament?

Wins by Country — Brazil Leads with 5 Titles



Notable: Germany (4) includes 2 wins as West Germany (1954, 1974). Argentina's 3rd title came in 2022 under Lionel Messi. Only 8 nations have ever lifted the trophy.

FIFA WORLD CUP ANALYSIS

Performance, Goals & Hosting Effects (1930-2022)

Most Winning Nation
Brazil

All-Time Goals
2720

Tournaments Held
22

Host Country

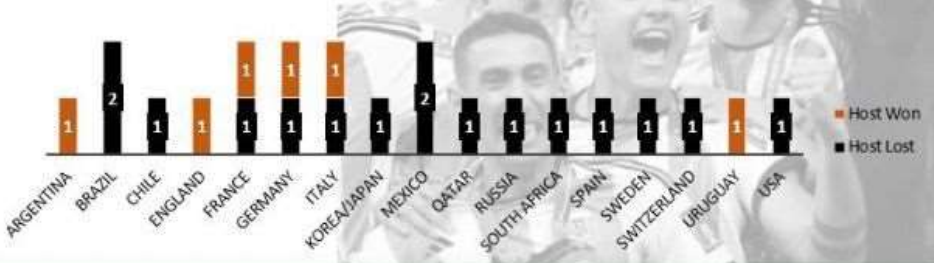
Year

Matches Played vs Goals

World Cup Wins by Country

Host Results

Hosting Advantage Analysis

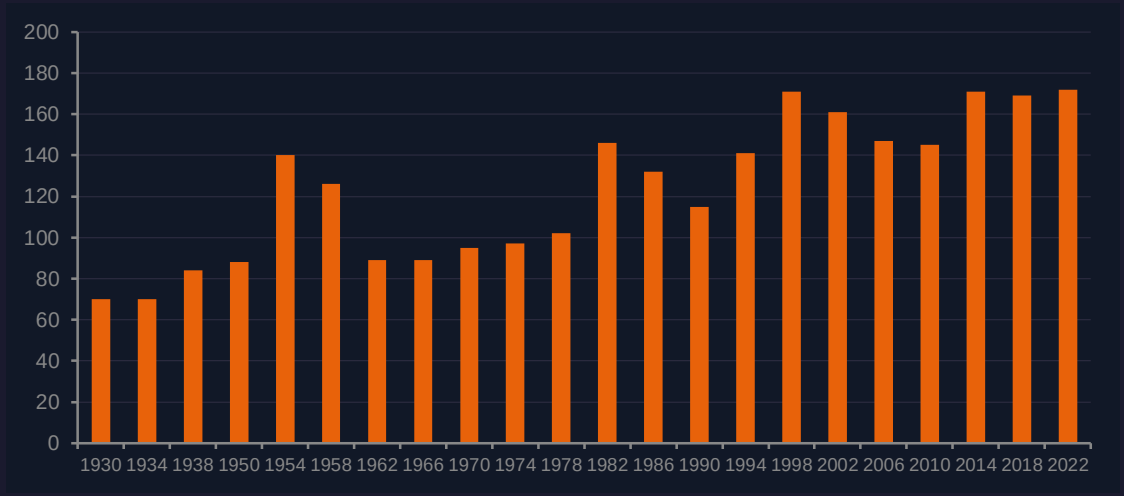


Goals Scored Over Time

Goals Analysis | Scoring Trends 1930 – 2022

Total Goals Scored Per Tournament — All 22 Editions

Goals Scored Per Tournament



Matches Played Per Tournament

172
Goals in 2022
Highest single tournament total

115
Goals in 1990
Lowest in modern era (post-1982)

2,720
All-Time Goals
Across all 22 tournaments

4.3
Goals Per Match
Average across all tournaments

Hosting Advantage Analysis | Does Home Turf Help?

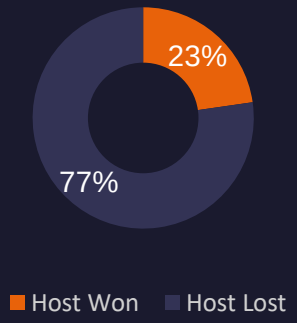
Of 22 Tournaments — Host Nations Won Only 5 Times

5
Host Nations Won

17
Host Nations Lost

22.7%
Host Win Rate

Host Result Breakdown



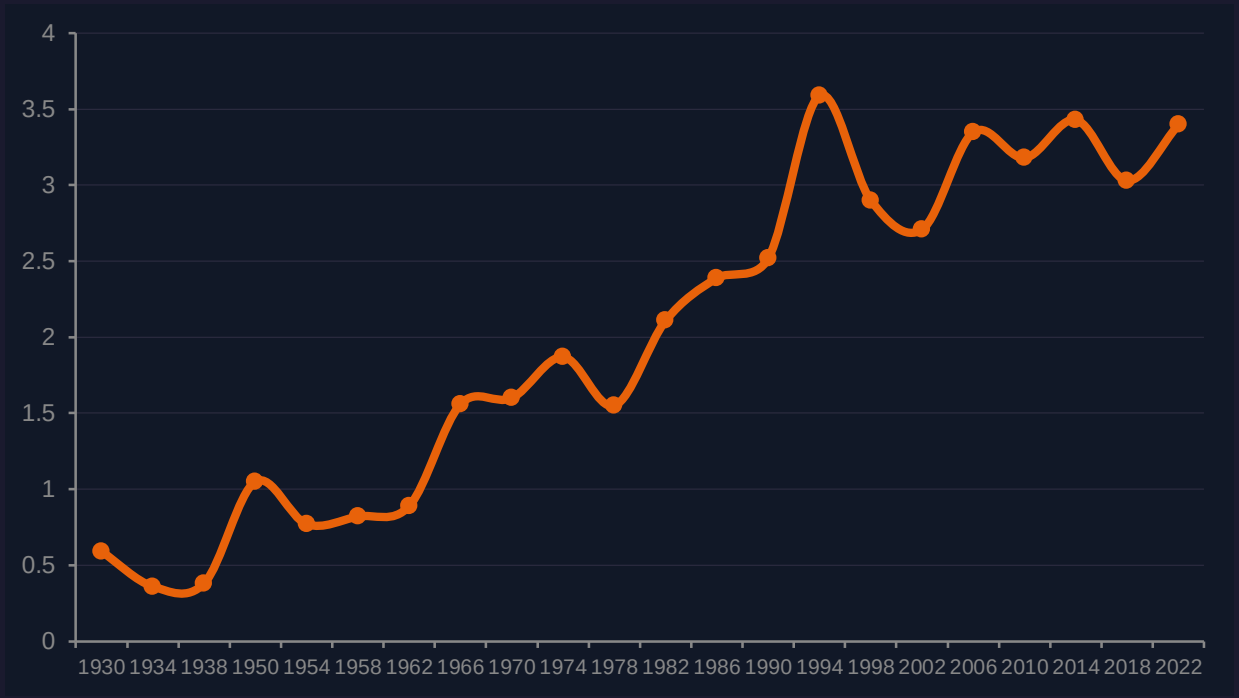
Hosts That Won Their Tournament

1930	Uruguay	First ever World Cup on home soil
1934	Italy	Mussolini-era Italy dominates at home
1966	England	Only World Cup win in England's history
1974	W. Germany	Hosts beat Netherlands 2-1 in the final
1998	France	Zidane's France wins 3-0 vs Brazil

Verdict: Hosting alone does not guarantee success. 77% of host nations failed to win despite home advantage, crowd support and reduced travel.

Attendance Trends | How Fan Turnout Has Evolved

Total Tournament Attendance Has Grown 6× Since 1930



3.59M
1994 USA
All-time record attendance

363K
1934 Italy
Lowest total ever recorded

3.40M
2022 Qatar
Highest in modern era

45.7K
Avg/Match
Average across all editions

Key Trend: Attendance dipped sharply in 2002 (Japan/Korea) and 2010 (South Africa) due to travel costs and stadium capacity constraints — but recovered strongly by 2014 and 2022.

Top Scorers | Golden Boot Winners Across the Decades

Tournament Top Scorers — 1930 to 2022

1930	Guillermo Stábile Argentina	8 goals
1954	Sándor Kocsis Hungary	11 goals
1958	Just Fontaine France	13 goals
1970	Gerd Müller West Germany	10 goals
1990	Salvatore Schillaci Italy	6 goals
2002	Ronaldo Brazil	8 goals
2006	Miroslav Klose Germany	5 goals
2014	James Rodríguez Colombia	6 goals
2018	Harry Kane England	6 goals
2022	Kylian Mbappé France	8 goals

Record: Just Fontaine's 13 goals in 1958 (France) remains the all-time single-tournament record and has stood for over 65 years. Kylian Mbappé scored 8 goals in 2022 including a hat-trick in the final.

Key Insights from the Data

What the Numbers Tell Us About 92 Years of World Cup Football

01 Brazil Stands Alone at the Top

With 5 titles, Brazil has won the World Cup more than any other nation. Their dominance spans 7 decades — from their first win in 1958 to their last in 2002. No other nation has been as consistently excellent across all eras.

02 Goals Are at an All-Time High

The 2022 Qatar World Cup produced 172 goals — the highest in tournament history. Modern football's high press, improved fitness and attacking strategies are driving an upward trend in goals per match in recent editions.

03 Hosting Does Not Guarantee Victory

Only 5 of 22 host nations have won the tournament on home soil — a 22.7% win rate. Being the host provides logistical and crowd advantages, but elite football quality ultimately determines the winner.

04 Attendance Peaked in 1994

The 1994 USA World Cup holds the record for highest total attendance at 3.59 million. Despite expansions to 32 teams, no subsequent tournament has matched this total — reflecting stadium size and geographic demand differences.

05 Just 8 Nations Have Ever Won

In 22 tournaments, only 8 countries — all European or South American — have ever lifted the World Cup trophy. Africa, Asia, North America and Oceania are yet to produce a World Cup winner, highlighting regional power gaps.

06 1990 Was the Least Entertaining on Paper

The 1990 Italy World Cup produced just 115 goals in 52 matches — a goals-per-match ratio of 2.21, the lowest in the modern era. Defensive tactics dominated, leading FIFA to introduce rule changes to encourage more attacking play.

Recommendations | Lessons for Teams, Hosts & Governing Bodies

Strategic Actions Based on the Analysis

1 Invest in Long-Term Youth Development

All 5 champions won the World Cup at home. But across 9 decades, Brazil, Germany, Italy and Argentina built winning cultures through elite youth academies. Nations must invest in grassroots football 10–15 years before targeting a title.

2 Host Nations Must Prepare Holistically

Of 22 hosts, only 5 won. Hosting success requires more than infrastructure — nations must align tournament hosting with a peak squad generation to maximise competitive chances on home soil.

3 Prioritise Attacking Football Strategies

Goal tallies have trended upward in modern tournaments. Nations that embrace attacking, high-press football (like France 2018 and Argentina 2022) achieve both results and fan engagement — a dual competitive advantage.

4 Expand Development Investment to New Regions

Only European and South American teams have ever won the World Cup. FIFA and continental bodies should redirect funding and coaching infrastructure to Africa, Asia and North America to create genuine global competition by 2030+.

5 Use Data Analytics for Opponent Preparation

With 92 years of match data available, national teams can leverage historical patterns — goal timing, host advantages, high-pressure moments — to build data-driven tactical frameworks for upcoming tournaments.

6 Plan Stadium Capacity to Break Attendance Records

The 1994 attendance record of 3.59M has not been broken in 30 years. Future hosts like 2026 USA/Canada/Mexico should leverage large-capacity NFL stadiums and multi-city formats to finally surpass this milestone.

Thank You

The Beautiful Game — A Data Story

Data Source: FIFA World Cup Dataset | Period: 1930 – 2022 | 22 Tournaments | 964 Matches

2,720	964	5×	22.7%
Total Goals	Total Matches	Brazil's Titles	Host Win Rate

The World Cup is not just football — it is history, culture and data.